Lithium Safety

Mental Health | Mood and Personality Disorders

REMEMBER IT AS

Salt and water keep lithium steady

- **Therapeutic range**
  About 0.6-1.2 mEq/L; levels above 1.5 mEq/L suggest toxicity.
- **Keep sodium and fluids steady**
  Low sodium or dehydration raises lithium levels.
- **Early toxicity**
  Nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, and a coarse hand tremor.

NURSE TIP

Hold the dose and report vomiting, diarrhea, or heavy sweating.